Asper Business Case Competition 2027 — HSBI Preparation

ABCC 2027 preparation · Repository root

Everything the HSBI team needs to **prepare for and compete at** the **Asper Business Case Competition (ABCC) 2027** — fifth annual edition, **February 18–22, 2027**, I. H. Asper School of Business, University of Manitoba, Winnipeg.

Team: four Masters students (finance · innovation · computer science · general business administration)
Coach / faculty advisor: Prof. Dr. Christoph Weisser

Reference map of every file: `DOCUMENTATION.md` · change history: `CHANGELOG.md` · *documentation verified 2026-08-05*

Where we are right now

Week 1 of 29 — Aug 3–9, 2026. Kick-off week. The calendar in `02-plan/week_by_week_plan.md` starts here; this week's job is to get the team formed and the admin clock running.

- ☐ Kick-off meeting with `08-briefing-slides/abcc_overview.pdf`; everyone reads `01-competition/handbook.md` afterwards
- ☐ Charter signed (`03-team/team_charter.md`), roles assigned (`03-team/role_playbooks.md`)
- ☐ Coach briefs the team on `03-team/coach_and_ai_rules.md` — AI is allowed, coach contact is not
- ☐ **Registration e-mail sent** to `aspercasecomps@umanitoba.ca` (`07-logistics/registration_email_draft.md`)
- ☐ Homework: `01-competition/past_cases.md` Part I; first pass at `04-training/exercises/format_quiz.md`

Then: Foundations to Sep 6 → skill building to Oct 11 → simulations under competition rules to Dec 20 → peak in January → prepared-case sprint in February.

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The competition in 60 seconds

Nine graduate teams of four compete over three days in **three case formats**, then a final round. Everything runs **in English**, PowerPoint only, judged by ~50 industry practitioners.

Round	Prep	Delivery	Weight
Prepared case	released ~2 weeks ahead, all resources incl. coach	25 min presentation + 15 min Q&A; deck due as `.pptx` by e-mail before arrival (**late = bottom of pool**)	**25 %**
Boardroom case	4 h on site, no coach contact	3-min *protected* pitch from **one summary slide** + 22-min judge discussion; one-page b/w judge brief handed to judges in advance	**30 %**
Traditional case	3 h on site, no coach contact	20 min presentation + 10 min Q&A; unlimited slides	**45 %**
Final	top 3 by weighted score; **decks frozen**	20 + 15 to a fresh panel	decides the winner

Standing conditions: internet **and Generative AI allowed** during prep · one laptop per student, no phones or smartwatches · prebuilt own templates permitted · every team member must speak in every round · yellow card at 5 min, red at 1 min · **naming your school to a judge = disqualification**.

Field and history: 2025 saw Asper, Beedie, DeGroote, HEC Montréal, Ivey, John Molson, Levene, Memorial, Telfer. 2026 (fourth edition) included the first international team — Babeș-Bolyai, Romania — which **won outright**, ahead of DeGroote and HEC Montréal. That is the precedent this team is following.

> ***Watch the weekday question.*** *Feb 18–22, 2027 falls **Thursday–Monday**, but every edition in the current format has started on a **Wednesday** (2024, 2025, 2026 — three in a row), so 2027 as published would break the pattern. Either the window is exact, or the real week is Wed Feb 17 – Sun Feb 21. Every day-sheet here assumes the published window with the 2025 round order and says so in place. Details:* `01-competition/facts_and_rules.md`.

Full validated rule base: `01-competition/facts_and_rules.md` — **the single source of truth** for every rule claim in every other document.

The repository

Eight numbered folders follow the lifecycle of the project: *understand the competition → plan → form the team → train → practice → build assets → operate → brief.* **62 files**, of which **42 markdown documents, ≈84,000 words**. **Every folder opens with its own `README.md`** — what is inside, in what order to use it, and the hard rules that apply — so you can navigate by clicking rather than by searching.

Folder	Contents
`01-competition/`	Rules & facts (**source of truth**), handbook, official judging scoresheet + external-judge briefing, past-case dossier with ten re-crack briefs, and six official case PDFs
`02-plan/`	Preparation concept, dated week-by-week calendar (**governs on date conflicts**), simulation log
`03-team/`	Team charter, role playbooks incl. the GenAI operating procedure, coach & AI rules one-pager
`04-training/`	The core skills trio — presentation & storyline guide, Q&A drills (60 questions), business math (40 drills) — plus the framework selector, English phrasebook + 87 flashcards, and the **exercise program** in `04-training/exercises/`: 25-question format quiz, four solved workbooks, week-mapped catalog, ≈200 items
`05-practice-cases/`	Three original full cases (traditional / boardroom / prepared, with teaching notes), mini-cases 1–12, model answers
`06-templates/`	The 14-slide team skeleton, six case-type skeletons (A–F), case-type playbook, financial toolkit (xlsx), judge-brief template (docx)
`07-logistics/`	Registration e-mail draft to the organizers, competition-day runbook
`08-briefing-slides/`	Kick-off Beamer deck — LaTeX source + the 25-page PDF

What each individual file is, and when to use it: `DOCUMENTATION.md` §2. Every file has one canonical location, every path in every document is relative to this root, and the sixteen longest documents carry their own table of contents.

The eight commits of this material's earlier life as a nested repository (v1–v8, before it was flattened into one) are preserved on the **`archive-history`** branch: `git log archive-history`.

Quick start

New team member — first 90 minutes. Read `01-competition/handbook.md` → skim `02-plan/week_by_week_plan.md` for the weeks ahead → read your section of `03-team/role_playbooks.md` → sign `03-team/team_charter.md` → take `04-training/exercises/format_quiz.md` (target: 25/25 by W3).

Coach. `03-team/coach_and_ai_rules.md` (what you may and may not do, round by round) → `01-competition/judging_scoresheet.md` (print one per simulation judge) → `02-plan/week_by_week_plan.md` (run the calendar) → `02-plan/simulation_log.md` (log the same day).

Anyone maintaining the material. `DOCUMENTATION.md` — §2 for the file inventory, §5 for the maintenance rules and the propagation order when the 2027 guide lands, §7 for what has been verified and how. Then `CHANGELOG.md`.

Next actions beyond this week (this week's checklist is at the top):

1. **From W11:** the simulation cadence starts — ten simulations under competition rules, logged in `02-plan/simulation_log.md`. Download the five non-mirrored official cases before the sessions that use them (W14, W25).
2. **Watch for the 2027 Competition Guide** — the sponsor page and @Asper_BCC from autumn; case writing starts around October. When it lands, follow the propagation order in `DOCUMENTATION.md` §5.

Core workflows

Kick-off (W1). Present the briefing deck → everyone reads the handbook → sign the charter → assign roles → send the registration e-mail.

A normal training week (Phases 2–3). One 3–5 h weekend block (simulation or workshop) per the calendar → one 60–90 min midweek debrief plus a skill session from `04-training/` → 30 min of individual drills (math routine, flashcards). A mini-case opens the midweek session. If a week collapses, the priority order is **simulation > mini-case > workbook item > individual drills** — protect the simulations above all.

Running a simulation. Pick the case from the week plan → coach prints `01-competition/judging_score-sheet.md` → run under competition-identical conditions (timed, one laptop each, internet + GenAI allowed, **no coach contact**, `.pptx` "USB" hand-in at the deadline, all four speak, yellow/red cards) → score on the official rubric → 2 strengths / 2 gaps / 1 drill per person → enter results in `02-plan/simulation_log.md` → goals carry into the next week.

When a case lands (competition or graded sim). Classify the type within 10 minutes using `06-templates/case_type_playbook.md` → duplicate the matching skeleton from `06-templates/case-type-templates/`, **delete its red briefing slide**, rename to the round's file convention → storyline pass, **titles first** → parallel build along the role minute-maps → every number through `06-templates/case_financial_-toolkit.xlsx` → for boardroom rounds fill `06-templates/judge_brief_template.docx`, wording mirroring the summary slide.

Prepared-case sprint (on release, ~2 weeks). Follow Phase 4 of `02-plan/preparation_plan.md` day by day. Coach input **is** allowed in this round. Submit the `.pptx` by e-mail **at least 24 h before the deadline**, file named `[Team Name] Prepared Case`.

Competition week. `07-logistics/competition_day_runbook.md` is the daily script; the standing rules at its top apply all week.

After. Debrief in the week of Feb 23, write thank-yous, and hand the repository to the next team (final section of the week plan).

Step-by-step detail for each of these: `DOCUMENTATION.md` §4.

The rubric — and what it means for training

The official ABCC rubric (2025 Event Guide) applies to **all rounds**, 7 categories, max 105 points:

Category	Weight	What judges ask
Implementation & resources	**2.5×**	Is there a clear path to follow, with resources, time, and financial considerations?
Analysis	2.0×	Is the assessment substantiated by research, logic, quantitative and qualitative analysis?
Recommendation	2.0×	Effective, clear, comprehensive, strategically fitting?
Communicating effectively	1.0×	Clear, professional, compelling delivery and a readable deck?
Framing the problem	1.0×	Are issues wrapped into a clear, solvable summary (primary + secondary)?
Impact	1.0×	Quantitative and qualitative benefit to the organization?
Measurement, risks & mitigation	1.0×	Progress measurement and realistic risk mitigation?

Training implication. Implementation & Resources alone is worth more than any other category — 2.5× is nearly a quarter of the sheet. Every mock presentation must end with a **concrete, resourced, costed implementation plan with owners, timing, and KPIs**. Drill it explicitly in `04-training/exercises/workbook3_-storyline_and_slides.md`.

Rules cheat sheet: AI, coach, anonymity

AI is explicitly allowed. The official rules permit internet use during timed prep, including "any login-required website … filesharing websites, **and Generative AI**." That covers the 4-h boardroom and 3-h traditional prep; in the prepared case all resources are allowed anyway.

Because every team has the same arsenal, the edge is a **drilled procedure**, not access (`03-team/role_playbooks.md`, GenAI SOP): one designated operator (CS & analytics lead), narrow sanctioned tasks (checking math, stress-testing the recommendation, generating counterarguments, polishing brief wording, the 10-minute Q&A-anticipation routine), and the hard rule that **no unverified number reaches a slide**. Framing, option choice, and the recommendation are never outsourced — borrowed logic collapses in the 22-minute discussion. **Confidentiality caution:** competition cases are confidential documents, so do not paste full case text into consumer AI tools; prefer university-licensed enterprise tools and work from your own summaries. Re-check the 2027 guide for new AI clauses before the competition.

The coach is in the game for the prepared case (unrestricted — faculty input explicitly allowed), for everything before the competition, and on site for presentations, feedback sessions, and the full social program.

The coach goes silent from the moment a **boardroom** or **traditional** case is released until the team has presented — no contact of any kind. Any communication between coach and team during a presentation or Q&A, or any coach intervention in the question period, means **immediate disqualification**. Advisors of finalist teams may not communicate with their team until after it has presented.

Anonymity binds everyone, coach included. Nothing said, worn, or shown may identify HSBI. The team competes under **a fictional consulting name it chooses itself** and registers with the organizers before the event, plus a **division letter A–I drawn at on-site registration** that sets the week's presentation slots — the name is ours, the letter is theirs. Identifying your school to a judge = disqualification. This is why every template here is deliberately clean of HSBI branding — **never commit the HSBI name into a slide template or judge brief.**

Timeline and milestones

Date	Milestone
Aug 3–9, 2026 (now)	**W1 kick-off:** deck presented, charter signed, roles assigned; **registration e-mail sent**
Sep–Oct 2026	Organizer answers logged; the simulation calendar starts
Nov 2026	**Team `.pptx` template v1** built (anonymity-proof)
Dec 2026	Template v2 frozen after use in three simulations
Late Jan 2027	Taper begins; prepared-case sprint ready to launch
~Feb 4, 2027 *(TBA)*	**Prepared case released** → 14-day sprint
~Feb 17, 2027 *(TBA)*	**Prepared deck submitted** ≥24 h before the deadline
Thu Feb 18 – Mon Feb 22, 2027	**ABCC 2027**
Week of Feb 23	Debrief, thank-yous, handover to the next team

Training phases: **Foundations** (W1–W5, Aug 3 – Sep 6) → **Skill building** (W6–W10, Sep 7 – Oct 11) → **Simulations under competition rules** (W11–W20, Oct 12 – Dec 20) → *Christmas, light load* (W21–W22) → **Peak** (W23–W26, Jan 4–31) → **Prepared-case sprint** (W27–W29, Feb 1–17).

The competition week, and the caveat. The 2025 pattern ran Wednesday arrival with registration and the division draw · Thursday prepared-case presentations and the museum social · Friday boardroom case and Festival du Voyageur · Saturday traditional case, finals and awards gala · Sunday departure. 2026 ran the same shape, also from a Wednesday. The published 2027 window (**Thu Feb 18 – Mon Feb 22**) would break that pattern, so the day-sheets in `07-logistics/competition_day_runbook.md` and the week-plan table map the 2025 order onto the published dates and mark every weekday *expected*. What the team drills is the *shape* of each day; the dates are a one-line edit when the agenda lands. First thing to reconcile then: which date carries which round.

Known limitations and open questions

- The **2027 agenda, deadlines, fees, and field are TBA** until the organizers publish them. Everything schedule-shaped is a 2025/2026-baseline assumption, flagged as such in place — and because 2027

runs Thursday–Monday against 2025's Wednesday–Sunday, the day-sheets will need re-mapping, not just re-dating.
- The three original practice cases and all worked model answers use **fictional, internally consistent data** (labelled as case data); teaching-note figures are calibration aids, not real-company facts.
- **Eligibility of the specific HSBI student mix needs written confirmation** from the organizers — the top open question in `01-competition/facts_and_rules.md`.
- Eleven official past cases exist across ten clients (2023 ran both rounds on Manitoba Hydro). **Six PDFs are mirrored** in `01-competition/past-case-pdfs/`; the remaining five (2024 cases 1 and 3, all three 2026 cases) are linked by URL in `facts_and_rules.md` and `01-competition/past_cases.md` — download them before the sessions that need them (W14, W25).

Open questions to put to the organizers after registration — all four are covered by `07-logistics/registration_email_draft.md`: 2027 agenda and prepared-case release/submission dates · registration process and fee for an international (German) team and what it covers, plus eligibility confirmation · roster, bio and photo requirements plus advisor registration · whether the 2027 rules package changes anything against the 2025 baseline, **specifically any new generative-AI clauses**.

Provenance. All competition facts were researched and validated (July–August 2026) against the official Asper website, the official **ABCC 2025 Event Guide** (the fullest public rulebook), the official past-case PDFs, and press coverage. The materials went through a multi-agent adversarial review: rule claims verified against the fact base, all exhibit arithmetic recomputed, all official URLs link-checked. Every document flags where 2027 specifics are still TBA. The documentation itself — structure, inventory, counts, cross-references — was re-verified on **2026-08-04**; see `DOCUMENTATION.md` §7 for what was and was not checked. No official URL was re-fetched on that date, so all competition facts still carry their July–August 2026 validation.

Sources and contacts

Organizers: `aspercasecomps@umanitoba.ca` — Judith Jayasuriya (Instructor & Lead, Experiential Learning), Steven Harrison (Case Competition Coordinator, +1 204 396 9631) · Instagram **@Asper_BCC Venue:** Drake Centre, Asper School of Business, 181 Freedman Crescent, Winnipeg (venues can vary by day)

- Official ABCC page (2027): https://umanitoba.ca/asper/asper-business-case-competition
- Case competitions hub (past cases): https://umanitoba.ca/asper/student-experience/case-competitions
- **ABCC 2025 Event Guide** (schedule, rules, rubric): https://umanitoba.ca/asper/sites/asper/files/2025-01/abcc25-eventguide.pdf
- 2026 recap (fourth edition, first international winner): https://umtoday.ca/stories/forging-worldwide-relationships-2026-asper-business-case-competition

Publishing. To put this on a private remote:

```
gh repo create asper-abcc-2027 --private --source=. --push
# or: git remote add origin git@github.com:<user>/asper-abcc-2027.git && git push -u origin main
```

> ***Confidentiality.*** *The official case PDFs in `01-competition/past-case-pdfs/` are © University of Manitoba and are competition documents marked "no reproduction or transmission" — internal team use only. Do not redistribute them, and keep this repository **private**.*